reconciliation of accounts, strengthen management information systems (MIS), improve accuracy and timeliness in accounts preparation, bring about transparency and efficiency in public delivery systems, help bring about better financial management along with improved quality of governance in states and UTs. The overall estimated cost of the scheme is Rs. 626 crore at Rs. 1 crore per district in existence on 1 April 2011. Financial support is up to 75 per cent (90 per cent in case of northeastern states) of the individual project cost of admissible components limited to Rs. 75 lakh per district (Rs. 90 lakh per district for north-eastern states). Funds will be released as central assistance in three instalments of 40 per cent, 30 per cent, and 30 per cent each, subject to satisfactory receipt of utilisation certificates.

CRIS OF INDIA

The Finance Ministry of India has developed and released *(January 31, 2012)* the ***Comparative Rating Index of Sovereigns (CRIS)*** *– a new index of sovereign credit rating.* Together with it, the Ministry has also released an estimation of CRIS over the **last five years**, for **different nations** belonging to different blocks of the global economy.

Major credit rating agencies give out the sovereign credit rating of each nation as an absolute grade. How other nations fare does not matter in a particular nation's rating score. The CRIS is very different from a comparative rating. An example of comparative rating is the percentile score – the way *GRE (Graduate Record Examination)* results are at times given. If a student is described as belonging to the 99th percentile, it clearly says something about this student's performance vis-à-vis other students.

It is arguable that even for sovereign credit ratings, there is a case for providing some kind of a comparative score. When an investor searches across nations for a place to put her money, the relative rating of nations is important. If nation **y's** rating remaining the same, other nations' ratings improve over time, there may well be a case to invest less in nation **y.**

The computation of CRIS is based on nothing apart from ***Moody's*** ratings and data on the GDPs of different nations as given by the ***IMF***. In the